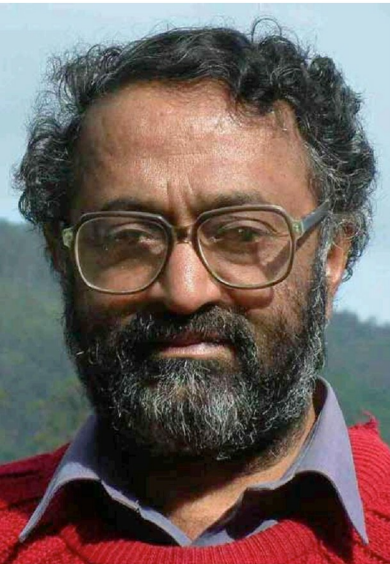




A Tribute to Kenneth Gonsalves The Man Who Truly *Lived* Open Source Technology

Kenneth Gonsalves... People active in the Indian open source space will be familiar with this name. He was a strong personality and a man who never minced his words. We lost him on August 3, 2012.

Kenneth Gonsalves was an inspiration to many. He was a philosopher and guide to new entrants to the open source world, a constant reference point for the current users, and a guard against those who tried to mess with the technology.

Gonsalves was active on a majority of Linux User Groups in India. A lawyer by profession and fondly called Lawgon, his love for open source technology made him an eminent protagonist in the Free Software Movement. Ramadass, a.k.a. Amachu, who had been in close contact with Gonsalves, remembers him as someone who was a “user, developer and mentor of open source technology.” Ramadass said, “Kenneth contributed to open source technology in every possible way. He lived open source technology and showed this way of life to others as well.”

Kenneth: The techie

Gonsalves was known for his amazing Python programming skills. He also had a good grasp of Django Web application development. He was one of the key persons involved in the setting up of the Python Software Society, India. He also made major contributions to Tamil computing and Open Streetmap.

Jaganadh G, an open source enthusiast and a close friend of Gonsalves said, “KG was a great mentor to many successful FOSS professionals. His thoughts, vision and software development practices were unique. He was very selective about the operating system flavours, tools and RDBMS... He was a person who practised what he preached. His personality, mode of FOSS development and community management strategies should be an example for others too.”

Some of his FOSS projects are unique, like *Djangogolf* (a golf management system), *avasp* and *avaspdjango* (a financial accounting system). Gonsalves always remembered to carry a GPS device around with him to map the places that he visited.

Yogesh Girikumar, an admirer of Gonsalves and an open source enthusiast, said, “Kenneth contributed to open source by the way of code as well as advocacy. He has helped numerous ‘newbies’ technically and was a vocal advocate of open source software. He had strong opinions on several people involved in FOSS regarding their ideologies and practices. He was also involved in NRC-FOSS. He was an educator, evangelist and an all-out programmer.”

Kenneth on mailing lists

Many FOSS lovers know Gonsalves because of their interactions with him on mailing lists. He was very active on the Django mailing list, the Bangalore Python Users Group mailing list, the ILUG-CBE mailing list and many others. He always wanted to ensure that the interactions happening were smooth and as per the guidelines of the FOSS mailing list.